MEETING NOTE · CONFIDENTIAL

Instinct for SmartBazaar via JioMart

AI Agent Commerce · WhatsApp-First Ordering · Pilot Scoping

DATE	October 15, 2026
CHAIR	Damodar Mall
FORUM	Instinct for SmartBazaar — Bilateral
ATTENDEES	Farooq Adam (Fynd), Damodar Mall (SmartBazaar), Amit (observer)
NEXT CHECKPOINT	Farooq shares first prototype build — early next week

1. Executive Summary

Damodar Mall opened the conversation by signalling a strategic inflection point: with JioMart's role as a digital commerce channel becoming uncertain, SmartBazaar needs an alternative path for digital interaction and home delivery that does not depend on a third-party marketplace. The discussion converged on a concept Farooq labelled 'Instinct for SmartBazaar' — an AI agent that accepts voice or handwritten WhatsApp shopping lists from customers and builds and routes an order cart entirely within SmartBazaar's own fulfilment stack.

The core idea leverages three existing strengths: SmartBazaar's one-store-one-customer relationship data, Fynd's platform and fulfilment OMS (already powering JioMart execution rails), and frontier voice/AI models (Claude voice mode, Instinct-style agents) that eliminate app friction. Damodar cited internal data showing digital delivery capability increases family basket size by 34%. The agent would decode lists, surface personalised substitutions based on purchase history, and respond in the voice of the store manager — including voice cloning to maintain customer familiarity across staff changes.

Farooq committed to having a small, fresh team hack a first-pass prototype over the weekend and share it with Damodar early next week. The pilot is to be kept as a 'sidecar' — outside mainstream platforms to avoid internal blockers — and targeted at a Tier 2+ market where external variables (JioMart competition, etc.) are minimal. Amit was identified as a value-add once the ongoing Granary project is complete.

2. Context — Beyond JioMart

Damodar framed the session around a strategic need: find digital commerce paths that compensate for JioMart's shrinking relevance for SmartBazaar. He noted the window is now open to think beyond any single marketplace and go direct to customers through channels the store itself controls.

- Digital delivery raises the family's basket size from a SmartBazaar store by 34% — a proven internal data point from earlier omnichannel pilots in Gaya, Bhuj, and Hathras.
- JioMart dependency is now a risk; SmartBazaar wants its own digital fulfilment capability.
- Damodar's framing: skip the app stage — go straight from physical store to an AI agent on WhatsApp.

3. The 'Instinct for SmartBazaar' Concept

Farooq crystallised the proposal: use an Instinct-style AI agent, accessed via WhatsApp, to receive voice or image-based shopping lists, decode them using the store's purchase history, confirm the interpreted cart with the customer, and route the final order to SmartBazaar's hybrid store OMS — the same execution rails already built for JioMart.

- Customer sends a voice note or photo of a handwritten list to the store's WhatsApp number.
- Agent decodes the list and applies personalisation (e.g. 'You said dahi — based on past purchase, that's Amul 400g').
- Confirmed order routes to the store's OMS; fulfilment is business as usual from that point.
- Agent speaks back in the store manager's voice — frontier voice cloning models make this feasible today.
- If the store manager changes, the new person's voice replaces the old one; the relationship continuity is maintained through the agent persona.

> *Use tech to become more human. That's the stickiness that can be discontinuous.*

4. Technology Landscape & Competitive Context

Both participants discussed the broader AI agent ecosystem informing this concept.

- Instinct (used by Damodar) and Muse (Meta) are 'do it for me' shopping agents that build multi-platform carts without opening individual apps.
- Damodar: 'I am scared because it can kill all branded retail platforms.'
- Meta's Muse noted as existential threat: it already knows how to monetize user data, so it doesn't need to solve revenue separately — unlike pure-tech AI companies.
- Farooq's framing: Big Tech harvests users as 'natural resources'; ads subconsciously engineer desire and context (the 'premium toothpaste' example).
- KT's Jio bot (shown to Farooq) demonstrated autonomous ordering — logging into Swiggy, capturing OTP, placing COD order — as a proof point that this tech stack is real and accessible.
- Claude voice mode (dictate vs. true voice-conversation) discussed as a useful input interface; Damodar already uses Instinct at 75% voice.

> *Today for the first time I did not open Google — Instinct is becoming one entry to the internet for everything.*

5. Pilot Design

Farooq and Damodar aligned on a lean, contained pilot approach.

Parameter	Decision
Target market	Tier 2+ (minimise JioMart/external variable noise)
Build approach	Sidecar — not in mainstream platforms; Farooq controls all layers
Team	Fresh, small team; Farooq leads; AI-first build methodology
Timeline	Weekend hack show Damodar early next week

Parameter	Decision
Fulfilment rails	Reuse existing JioMart OMS execution infrastructure
Field testing	Damodar's omnichannel pilot team (already convinced); deploy to consumers immediately after first-pass review

6. Damodar's Book & Content Strategy (Context)

Brief sidebar: Damodar's book pre-orders open with shipping from 30th. He is not doing a mega launch — instead increasing content presence by saying yes to all requests and building devotion ('the book is the prasad, not the product'). New chapters will be released on the platform rolling; hard-copy reprint will incorporate them. This context explains his framing of AI agents and Kirana-powered commerce — a chapter of the book covers AI-powered Kirana as a lethal competitive force.

> *I am selling devotion. If you buy into the devotion, the book is the prasad you take home.*

7. Action Items

#	Item	Owner(s)	Deadline / Checkpoint
1	Assign a fresh, small team to hack a first-pass WhatsApp AI agent prototype over the weekend — voice/image list input → SmartBazaar OMS routing via existing JioMart execution rails.	Farooq Adam	Weekend — 18–19 Oct 2026
2	Share synthesised distillation of this conversation with all relevant stakeholders to align on next steps.	Farooq Adam	Today — 15 Oct 2026
3	Show completed first-pass prototype to Damodar Mall for review and feedback.	Farooq Adam	Early next week (Mon–Tue, 20–21 Oct 2026)
4	Try Claude voice mode (true voice-conversation, not just dictate) for a hands-on feel of the interface concept.	Damodar Mall	Immediately
5	Play around with Instinct agent to build intuitive understanding of the 'do it for me' commerce paradigm before next review.	Amit	Before next review
6	After Granary project is complete, engage Amit to contribute to the SmartBazaar AI agent initiative for 10x customer proposition expansion.	Farooq Adam	Post-Granary completion
7	Damodar to deploy the prototype to his omnichannel pilot team for immediate field testing with consumers once prototype is shared.	Damodar Mall	Upon prototype receipt

8. Sentiment & Tone Notes

For context, not minutes.

The conversation was energetic and exploratory throughout — both participants were clearly excited by the idea and built on each other's thoughts rapidly. Damodar set the tone early with genuine enthusiasm ('I am swept off my feet') and equally genuine concern about competitive risk from Meta/Instinct-type agents. This dual emotion —

excitement and fear — was the underlying driver of the session's urgency.

Farooq's posture was constructive and solution-oriented. He absorbed Damodar's framing quickly, connected it to existing Fynd infrastructure, and pivoted to execution within a few exchanges. He used a light touch to manage pace — reassuring Damodar that this is a 2-day build, not a Reliance-style 'everything wanted yesterday' situation, which Damodar visibly appreciated ('Don't treat me like the Reliance thing').

There was a brief, warm moment of alignment when Damodar referenced the Meta/Muse competitive threat and his son Harsh's assessment — Farooq deepened it with his 'context engineering the person' framing, which Damodar received enthusiastically ('Bravo, bravo'). This exchange reinforced mutual intellectual respect.

Closing posture was confident and collegial. Both parties left with clear ownership — Farooq builds, Damodar tests in field. No unresolved tension. Amit's role was gently scoped without confrontation.

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